Policy and Procedure

Policy #: HR09
Date Issued: October 2006
Effective Date: June 2006

Subject: DRESS CODE

Application: All Staff

Policy statement: The Orhganization expects its employees to dress in an appropriate manner consistent with a public service oriented atmosphere. Every employee must dress with a purpose that is geared to the workplace and each of our roles as representatives of the company. Every effort should be made to uphold a high standard of dress that is appropriate to the employee's work situation. Maintaining a professional, business-like appearance is important to the success of the company.

Guidelines:
There are factors involved that can help in determining the way in which employees dress at the company. First, the work we do, and second, the impression we wish to make. Our customers and co-workers deserve to be treated with respect that includes the manner in which we dress. The Organization relies on its employees to use their good taste, common sense, and sound judgment when dressing for work.

The following outlines the standard of dress for all employees.

1. Brooklyn Public Library's Identification Badge is part of the dress code and must be worn at all times while on duty.
2. All employees are expected to be neat, well groomed and suitably dressed for work according to job function and location.
3. Cleanliness and good hygiene are expected of all employees as a courtesy to our customers and co-workers and supports a positive and customer friendly environment.
4. Employees whose work involves heavy lifting, maintenance of buildings, machinery, or work in a hazardous area should wear clothing and shoes that are appropriate and in keeping with safety precautions.
5. Sincere religious beliefs as well as medical needs will be taken into consideration when determining compliance with this policy.
6. Employees are not permitted to wear clothing that is:
    a. Sexually provocative, including clothing where excessive skin or undergarments are exposed and/or;
    b. Imprinted clothing that presents sexually explicit, political or religious views or statements that may be offensive to others are not permitted.
7. For those positions where uniforms are required, they should be maintained in good condition.
8. Supervisors may authorize exceptions to the aforementioned standards of dress for special projects, building and weather conditions and other extenuating circumstances.
9. Employees in some positions may be required to wear additional safety clothing or equipment when performing certain tasks.

Reporting Guidelines:
All employees are encouraged to advise their immediate supervisor or Human Resources if they feel they have been exposed to offensive language, images, etc on articles of clothing worn by other employees of the company.

Application of Standards:
It is the responsibility of each employee to adhere to the Library's standard of dress. Employees inappropriately dressed for work may be required to go home and change into suitable clothing before returning to work. Employees generally will not be entitled to compensation for time spent away from the company and assigned duties if they are sent home for inappropriate attire. Repeated violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to, and including termination.

The company reserves the right to address concerns regarding extremes in appearance which may not be addressed in this policy. If you have any questions as to the appropriate standards of dress detailed in this policy, please speak with your manager or a representative from Human Resources.

Issuing Agency: Human Resources
Revision Date: June 2006
Related Public Documents:
Supersedes Policy:
Related Policy: